



Entrepreneurship and Professional Practice

Unit IV: Business Modeling, Planning and Pitching (6 Hrs)

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Level: Bachelor
Semester: IV/I

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4.1 Business canvas

- A **business canvas** is a strategic management tool that visually represents the key components of a business model.
- It helps entrepreneurs analyze, design, and communicate their business ideas clearly and effectively.
- Business canvases are widely used because they simplify complex business concepts into a single-page framework, enabling quick planning, brainstorming, and decision-making.
- Canvases are especially helpful for startups as they allow rapid experimentation, quick revisions, and improved teamwork during the early stages of business development.

4.1.1 Types of Business Canvases:

- Business canvases come in different formats, each serving a specific purpose. The three most commonly used ones are:

1. Business Model Canvas (BMC)

- Developed by Alexander Osterwalder, the **Business Model Canvas** is the most widely used framework to describe how a business creates, delivers, and captures value.
- It contains **nine building blocks**, which together describe the entire business model.

Key Components of BMC:

1. **Customer Segments** – The groups of people or organizations the business aims to serve.

4.1.1 Types of Business Canvases:

- 2. Value Propositions** – The products or services that provide value and solve customer problems.
- 3. Channels** – The methods through which value is delivered (online platforms, retail stores, etc.).
- 4. Customer Relationships** – How the company interacts with customers (self-service, personal support, automation).
- 5. Revenue Streams** – How the business earns money (sales, subscriptions, ads, commissions).
- 6. Key Resources** – Assets required to operate the business (people, technology, equipment).

4.1.1 Types of Business Canvases:

- 7. Key Activities** – The most important activities to deliver value (production, marketing, logistics).
- 8. Key Partnerships** – External partners and suppliers that help the business function.
- 9. Cost Structure** – The major costs involved in running the business.

Purpose of BMC:

- **Purpose of BMC:**
- Provides a holistic view of the business.
- Useful for strategic planning and investor presentations.
- Helps identify strengths, weaknesses, and opportunities.

2. Value Proposition Canvas (VPC)

- The **Value Proposition Canvas** focuses specifically on the match between **customer needs** and the **value the business offers**.
- It helps ensure that the product or service solves real customer problems and delivers meaningful benefits.

The canvas has two main parts:

A. Customer Profile

Includes:

- 1. Customer Jobs** – What customers are trying to achieve (functional, social, emotional).
- 2. Pains** – Problems, obstacles, and risks customers face.
- 3. Gains** – Positive outcomes and benefits customers want.

2. Value Proposition Canvas (VPC)

B. Value Map

Includes:

- 1. Products & Services** – What the business offers.
- 2. Pain Relievers** – How the product reduces customer problems.
- 3. Gain Creators** – How it creates benefits or added value.

Purpose of VPC:

Ensures product–market fit.

Helps businesses build solutions that directly address customer expectations.

Useful during product development and customer research.

3. Lean Canvas

- Developed by Ash Maurya, the **Lean Canvas** is a simplified, startup-focused version of the Business Model Canvas.
- It emphasizes problems, solutions, and risks — making it ideal for early-stage startups that must experiment quickly.

Key Components of Lean Canvas:

- 1. Problem** – Top customer problems or pain points.
- 2. Customer Segments** – Specific groups of target customers.
- 3. Unique Value Proposition (UVP)** – What makes the solution different or better.
- 4. Solution** – Proposed product/service features that solve the problems.

3. Lean Canvas

- 5. **Channels** – Methods used to reach customers.
- 6. **Revenue Streams** – How the business will earn money.
- 7. **Cost Structure** – Operational and development costs.
- 8. **Key Metrics** – Performance indicators to track progress.
- 9. **Unfair Advantage** – What competitors cannot easily copy (e.g., patents, expertise).

3. Lean Canvas

Purpose of Lean Canvas:

- Helps startups validate ideas quickly.
- Encourages experimentation and iteration.
- Focuses on customer problems and actionable solutions.

Difference Between the Three Canvases

Canvas Type	Focus Area	Best For
Business Model Canvas	Entire business model	Established businesses or planning full operations
Value Proposition Canvas	Customer needs & value alignment	Product design, customer research
Lean Canvas	Problem–solution fit & risks	Early-stage startups or new business ideas

Conclusion

- Business canvases are powerful tools that simplify business planning and help entrepreneurs understand, refine, and communicate their ideas clearly.
- The **Business Model Canvas**, **Value Proposition Canvas**, and **Lean Canvas** each serve different strategic purposes and are essential for developing strong, customer-centric, and sustainable business models.

4.2 Business Plan

4.2 Business Plan

- A **business plan** is a formal written document that outlines the vision, goals, strategies, financial projections, and operational plans of a business.
- It acts as a roadmap for entrepreneurs, guiding them from idea to execution.
- Business plans are essential for strategic planning, attracting investors, securing loans, and managing business growth.

4.2.1 Importance of Business Plan

A business plan plays a critical role in the success and sustainability of a startup. Key importance includes:

1. Provides Strategic Direction

- A business plan offers a clear roadmap by defining the business goals, target market, competitive advantage, operational procedures, and long-term strategies.
- It helps entrepreneurs stay focused and make informed decisions.

2. Helps Attract Investors and Funding

- Investors, lenders, and financial institutions require a strong business plan to evaluate the feasibility, growth potential, and profitability of a startup.
- A well-structured plan increases the chances of raising capital.

4.2 Business Plan

3. Identifies Risk and Challenges

- Writing a business plan forces entrepreneurs to analyze potential risks, industry trends, competition, and challenges.
- This helps in preparing mitigation strategies and improving the business model.

4. Enhances Coordination and Communication

- A business plan ensures that all team members share a common understanding of objectives, roles, and responsibilities.
- It aligns efforts within the organization.

4.2 Business Plan

5. Guides Financial Planning

The plan includes revenue projections, cost estimates, breakeven analysis, and funding requirements. This helps in budgeting, resource allocation, and monitoring financial performance.

6. Supports Performance Evaluation

By comparing actual performance with the business plan, entrepreneurs can measure progress, identify gaps, and make necessary adjustments.

4.2.2 Contents of a Successful Business Plan

(1)

A well-structured business plan typically includes the following components:

1. Executive Summary

- A brief overview of the business, including the concept, mission, value proposition, financial highlights, and funding needs.
- It is often written last but placed at the beginning.

2. Company Description

Explains the nature of the business, vision and mission statements, goals, legal structure, location, and the problem the business aims to solve.

3. Market Analysis

Includes industry overview, target market, customer profile, market needs, competitor analysis, and market trends.

4.2.2 Contents of a Successful Business Plan (2)

4. Organization and Management

Details the organizational structure, roles and responsibilities, founders' backgrounds, advisory board, and staffing plan.

5. Products and Services

- Describes the offerings, features, benefits, unique selling points (USP), and product lifecycle.
- It may also include research and development plans.

6. Marketing and Sales Strategy

Outlines branding, pricing strategy, distribution channels, promotional activities, customer acquisition plan, and sales strategy.

4.2.2 Contents of a Successful Business Plan

(3)

7. Business Model / Operational Plan

Explains day-to-day operations, production process, suppliers, logistics, facilities, and technology needed to deliver value.

8. Financial Plan

- Contains revenue model, projected income statements, cash flow statements, balance sheets, breakeven analysis, and required capital.
- It may also include assumptions and sensitivity analysis.

9. Funding Requirements

Specifies the amount of funding needed, purpose of the funds, expected return, exit strategy for investors, and future financial needs.

4.2.2 Contents of a Successful Business Plan (4)

10. Appendices

- Supporting documents such as resumes of founders, market research data, product diagrams, legal documents, or additional financial analyses.

4.3 Business pitch

- A **business pitch** is a brief and persuasive presentation used to communicate a business idea, product, or startup model to potential stakeholders.
- The purpose of a pitch is to generate interest, secure funding, gain support, build partnerships, or acquire customers.
- A strong pitch demonstrates the value of the idea, its feasibility, and the competence of the founding team.

4.3.1 Contents of a Successful Idea Pitch for Different Stakeholders

- The structure of a pitch varies based on the target stakeholder—investors, customers, partners, or accelerators.
- However, a successful pitch usually includes the following key components:

1. Problem Statement

- Clearly explain the problem or pain point faced by the target customer.
- This helps stakeholders understand the need for your solution.

2. Solution

- Present your product or service that solves the identified problem.
- Highlight how it is unique, practical, and impactful.

4.3.1 Contents of a Successful Idea Pitch for Different Stakeholders

3. Value Proposition

Explain what makes your solution better than competitors — faster, cheaper, easier, more innovative, or more efficient.

4. Market Opportunity

Show the size of the market (TAM, SAM, SOM), growth potential, customer segment, and the demand for your solution.

5. Business Model

Describe how the business will make money — revenue streams, pricing model, cost structure, and scalability.

4.3.1 Contents of a Successful Idea Pitch for Different Stakeholders

6. Traction (if available)

Include early achievements such as prototypes, pilot testing, customer feedback, sales numbers, partnerships, or user growth.

7. Competitive Analysis

Explain the competitors in the market and clarify your competitive advantages or unique strengths.

8. Go-To-Market (GTM) Strategy

Show how you plan to reach customers — marketing channels, partnerships, promotional strategies, and sales plan.

4.3.1 Contents of a Successful Idea Pitch for Different Stakeholders

9. Financial Projections

Provide a summary of expected revenue, expenses, profitability, and timeline for growth.

10. Team

Introduce key members, their skills, expertise, and why they are capable of executing the idea successfully.

11. Funding Requirements

State how much money you need, how you will use it, and what returns or results investors can expect.

12. Closing Statement / Call to Action

End with a strong closing that reinforces the opportunity and asks for action — investment, partnership, or support.

4.3.1 Contents of a Successful Idea Pitch for Different Stakeholders

Different Stakeholders May Require Different Focus

Stakeholder	What They Focus On
Investors	Profitability, scalability, ROI, team, financials
Customers	Benefits, features, price, solution to their problem
Partners	Collaboration benefits, synergy, mutual gains
Accelerators/Incubators	Innovation, feasibility, growth potential

4.3.2 Pitch Delivery Skills (0)

- Delivering a pitch effectively is just as important as the content itself.
- Good delivery ensures clarity, confidence, and engagement.

1. Clarity

- Use simple, concise language. Avoid jargon.
- Make your message easily understandable.

2. Confidence

- Maintain strong body language, eye contact, and a steady voice.
- Investors invest in people as much as ideas.

4.3.2 Pitch Delivery Skills (1)

3. Storytelling

- Present the idea as a compelling story — problem, hero (your solution), and transformation.
- Stories create emotional connection.

4. Time Management

- Respect time limits (often 3–5 minutes).
- Prioritize essential points and avoid unnecessary details.

5. Visual Aids

- Use clean and minimal slides with images, graphs, and keywords.
- Avoid clutter.

4.3.2 Pitch Delivery Skills (2)

6. Engagement

Ask rhetorical questions, share real examples, or include short demonstrations to keep the audience interested.

7. Handling Questions

- Be prepared for Q&A. Answer honestly and confidently.
- If you don't know something, admit it and offer to follow up.

8. Voice Modulation

- Use variation in tone, pitch, and pace to maintain interest.
- Avoid speaking too fast or too flat.

Summary

- A successful business pitch combines **strong content** (problem, solution, market, team, financials) with **effective delivery** (clarity, confidence, storytelling, timing).
- It convinces stakeholders that the idea is valuable, realistic, and worth supporting.

4.3.2 Pitch Delivery Skills

9. Practice

Rehearse multiple times to reduce mistakes, improve timing, and strengthen delivery.

10. Professional Appearance

Dress appropriately and maintain a positive, enthusiastic attitude.